# CBSE CLASS X – SOCIAL SCIENCE (087)

# SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER 2026–27

## SET – 2 | BOARD EXAMINATION PRACTICE

**Time Allowed: 3 Hours**

**Maximum Marks: 80**

### GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. The question paper contains 38 questions divided into four sections: History, Geography, Political Science and Economics.

2. All questions are compulsory.

3. Each section carries 20 marks.

4. Internal choices are provided in selected questions.

5. Questions include MCQs, very short-answer, short-answer, long-answer, case-based and map-based questions.

6. Map work carries 5 marks: 2 marks in History and 3 marks in Geography.

7. Answers should be written according to the marks allotted.

8. This is an original practice set, not a guaranteed prediction of the actual board paper.

## SECTION A: HISTORY

20 Marks

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### Multiple-Choice Questions

Q1. What was the main objective of the Treaty of Vienna of 1815? (1)

a) To establish democratic governments throughout Europe

b) To restore monarchies and establish a new balance of power in Europe

c) To promote the unification of Germany under democratic leadership

d) To abolish conservative political institutions

Q2. Which of the following was a major feature of the Rowlatt Act of 1919? (1)

a) It granted complete independence to India.

b) It allowed detention without trial under specified circumstances.

c) It introduced universal adult franchise.

d) It abolished all restrictions on the press.

Q3. Which group was particularly concerned about the economic effects of colonial forest laws in India? (1)

a) European industrialists alone

b) Tribal and forest-dependent communities

c) British officials living in England

d) Foreign banking institutions

Q4. Which invention contributed significantly to the expansion of the printing revolution in Europe? (1)

a) Steam engine

b) Spinning jenny

c) Printing press using movable metal type

d) Telegraph

### Very Short Answer Question

Q5. Explain any two ways in which the First World War created a new economic and political situation in India. (2)

### Short Answer Question

Q6. Explain any three reasons why the Civil Disobedience Movement attracted different social groups in India. (3)

OR

Explain three ways in which the ideas of liberal nationalism influenced nineteenth-century Europe.

### Long Answer Question

Q7. Explain the role of Mahatma Gandhi in transforming the Indian national movement into a mass movement. Give five points. (5)

OR

Describe the process through which Germany was unified under the leadership of Prussia. Explain the major stages of unification.

### Case-Based Question

Q8. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow. (4)

Nationalism in Europe developed through a combination of political ideas, cultural movements and struggles against conservative rule. Romantic artists and poets attempted to create a sense of shared heritage by emphasising folk traditions, language and collective memories. Such cultural expressions helped people imagine themselves as members of a common nation. However, nationalist movements sometimes excluded groups that did not fit their dominant cultural identity.

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8.1. What is meant by nationalism? (1)

8.2. How did folk songs and folk traditions contribute to the growth of nationalism? (1)

8.3. Explain two ways in which culture contributed to the development of national identity in Europe. (2)

### Map-Based Question

Q9. On an outline political map of India, locate and label the following places. (2)

a) The place where the Indian National Congress session was held in September 1920. (1)

b) The place associated with the launch of the Dandi March in 1930. (1)

## SECTION B: GEOGRAPHY

20 Marks

### Multiple-Choice Questions

Q10. Which of the following is an example of a non-renewable resource? (1)

a) Solar energy

b) Wind energy

c) Coal

d) Tidal energy

Q11. Which soil is generally characterised by high fertility and is widely found in the northern plains of India? (1)

a) Laterite soil

b) Alluvial soil

c) Arid soil

d) Forest soil

Q12. Which of the following is a major cause of water scarcity in many parts of India? (1)

a) Complete absence of agricultural activity

b) Over-exploitation of groundwater and increasing demand

c) A permanent surplus of rainfall

d) A complete absence of industries

Q13. Which of the following crops is generally grown as a kharif crop in India? (1)

a) Wheat

b) Gram

c) Mustard

d) Rice

Q14. Why are iron and steel industries often located near sources of raw materials? (1)

a) To eliminate the need for transportation

b) To reduce the cost of transporting bulky raw materials

c) To avoid access to electricity

d) To prevent the growth of urban centres

Q15. Assertion (A): Roadways have an important role in India's transportation system.

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Reason (R): Roadways provide relatively flexible transport and can connect areas that may not be served directly by railways. (1)

Choose the correct option.

a) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A.

b) Both A and R are true, but R does not correctly explain A.

c) A is true, but R is false.

d) A is false, but R is true.

## Very Short Answer Question

Q16. State any two reasons why resource planning is essential for India. (2)

## Long Answer Question

Q17. Explain five measures that can be adopted to control land degradation in India. (5)

OR

Explain five major problems faced by Indian agriculture and suggest suitable measures to address them.

## Case-Based Question

Q18. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow. (4)

Agriculture continues to provide livelihoods to a large proportion of India's population. However, farmers face challenges arising from irregular rainfall, small landholdings, inadequate irrigation and uncertain market prices. Improvements in irrigation, storage, transport, access to institutional credit and agricultural technology can help improve productivity and reduce risks.

18.1. Name one major climatic factor that influences agricultural production in India. (1)

18.2. Explain two ways in which irrigation can benefit Indian farmers. (2)

18.3. Why is institutional credit important for agricultural development? (1)

### Map-Based Question

Q19. On an outline political map of India, locate and label the following. (3)

a) The dam on the Sutlej River associated with the Bhakra-Nangal Project. (1)

b) The iron ore mine at Mayurbhanj in Odisha. (1)

c) Chennai, a major seaport on the eastern coast of India. (1)

## SECTION C: POLITICAL SCIENCE

20 Marks

### Multiple-Choice Questions

Q20. Which of the following best describes horizontal power sharing? (1)

a) Distribution of power between the Union and State Governments

b) Distribution of power among different social groups

c) Distribution of power among the legislature, executive and judiciary

d) Distribution of power between rural and urban local bodies

Q21. Which of the following is an example of a coming-together federation? (1)

a) India

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b) Belgium

c) Spain

d) United States of America

Q22. Which of the following is an important outcome of political competition in a democracy? (1)

a) Political parties become unnecessary.

b) Rulers are encouraged to respond to public demands.

c) Citizens lose the right to choose representatives.

d) Elections cease to be important.

Q23. Which of the following is a major challenge to democracy? (1)

a) Regular elections

b) Political participation

c) Lack of accountability and responsiveness

d) Constitutional government

### Very Short Answer Questions

Q24. Mention any two differences between a federal government and a unitary government. (2)

Q25. Explain any two ways in which women face inequality in Indian society. (2)

### Short Answer Question

Q26. Explain any three functions performed by the opposition parties in a democracy. (3)

### Long Answer Question

Q27. Explain five reasons why power sharing is desirable in a democracy. (5)

OR

Explain how decentralisation has strengthened democracy in India. Give five points.

### Case-Based Question

Q28. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow. (4)

Democracy is based on the principle that citizens should have an equal political voice. In a diverse country, the government must accommodate different social groups and provide opportunities for participation. Constitutional safeguards, representative institutions and the protection of minority rights help prevent the domination of one group over others. Democratic decision-making may take time, but it provides opportunities for consultation and correction.

28.1. What is meant by political equality? (1)

28.2. Explain two ways in which democratic institutions protect the interests of different social groups. (2)

28.3. Why is consultation important in democratic decision-making? (1)

## SECTION D: ECONOMICS

20 Marks

### Multiple-Choice Questions

Q29. Which of the following is a non-income indicator of development? (1)

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a) Per capita income

b) National income

c) Literacy rate

d) Total exports

Q30. Which of the following activities belongs to the primary sector? (1)

a) Manufacturing textiles

b) Mining iron ore

c) Providing insurance

d) Transporting finished goods

Q31. Underemployment occurs when: (1)

a) Every worker is employed according to their full productive capacity.

b) More people are engaged in an activity than are actually required.

c) No one participates in economic activity.

d) All workers receive identical wages.

Q32. Which institution supervises and regulates the formal banking system in India? (1)

a) Election Commission of India

b) Reserve Bank of India

c) National Human Rights Commission

d) Central Board of Secondary Education

Q33. Which of the following best describes collateral? (1)

a) A gift given to a borrower

b) An asset pledged by a borrower as security for a loan

c) Interest paid on a savings account

d) A subsidy provided to all consumers

Q34. Assertion (A): Globalisation has increased the integration of national economies.

Reason (R): Improvements in technology and reductions in certain trade and investment barriers have facilitated the movement of goods, services and investment across countries. (1)

Choose the correct option.

a) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A.

b) Both A and R are true, but R does not correctly explain A.

c) A is true, but R is false.

d) A is false, but R is true.

### Short Answer Questions

Q35. Differentiate between the organised and unorganised sectors on any three grounds. (3)

Q36. Explain any three advantages of formal sources of credit over informal sources of credit. (3)

Q37. Explain how Self-Help Groups help poor rural households, especially women, gain access to credit. Give three points. (3)

### Case-Based Question

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Q38. Read the passage and answer the questions that follow. (5)

A farmer needs money to purchase seeds, fertilisers and agricultural equipment. A local moneylender offers an immediate loan but charges a very high rate of interest. A bank offers a loan at a lower interest rate, but the farmer must complete documentation and satisfy the bank's lending requirements. The farmer is also a member of a Self-Help Group whose members save small amounts regularly and provide loans to one another.

38.1. Which source of credit described in the passage is an informal source? (1)

38.2. Explain two advantages of borrowing from a bank rather than a moneylender. (2)

38.3. Explain two ways in which the Self-Help Group can improve the farmer's access to credit. (2)

OR

Explain why access to affordable credit is important for rural economic development. Give two reasons.

## END OF QUESTION PAPER

**Maximum Marks: 80**